

ENGLISH IN CHAPTERS

Level A2

Elementary / Pre-Intermediate

Grammar made short and clear

12 chapters · 3 examples per topic · appendix of further reference

by Carmen Crai

English Tutor for Professionals

Start

This guide turns Carmen's grammar cheat sheets into twelve short, numbered chapters for everyday English. Each chapter gives you the rule in plain words, three real examples, and a link to the Appendix for extra reference material drawn from the same source sheets — the Tenses table, the Prepositions summary, the Adverbs sheet, the Comparison Adjectives sheet, the Linking Words sheet, and the Modal Verbs sheet.

How to use this guide: read the rule, study the three examples, then follow the "See Appendix" link at the end of each chapter for extra reference material pulled from the same source sheets.

1. Present Tenses

Use the Present Simple for habits, routines and facts. Use the Present Continuous for an action happening now or at the moment of speaking.

Examples:

- I eat breakfast every day. (Present Simple — habit)
- I work every Friday. (Present Simple — routine)
- I am eating now / at the moment. (Present Continuous — action now)

→ See Appendix 1 for more examples

2. Past Tenses

Use the Past Simple for a finished action at a stated time. Use the Past Continuous for an action that was in progress in the past.

Examples:

- I ate an apple yesterday. (Past Simple)
- I worked last Saturday. (Past Simple)
- I was sleeping when you called me. (Past Continuous)

→ See Appendix 2 for more examples

3. Future Tenses

Use "will" + verb for future decisions and predictions. Use "will be" + verb-ing for an action that will be in progress at a future time.

Examples:

- I will eat later. (Future Simple — decision)
- She will go to Paris next week. (Future Simple — plan)
- She will be working until 3pm. (Future Continuous)

→ See Appendix 3 for more examples

4. Prepositions

Prepositions show place, time or movement. "At" is for precise points, "in" is for enclosed spaces, months and years, and "on" is for surfaces, days and dates.

Examples:

- Meet me at the station. (at — place/time)
- She lives in Spain. (in — place)
- The book is on the desk. (on — surface)

→ See Appendix 4 for more examples

5. Adverbs

Adverbs usually end in "-ly" and describe how, where or when an action happens. In a sentence they normally follow this order: manner, then place, then time.

Examples:

- She speaks softly. (adverb of manner)
- She left yesterday. (adverb of time)
- She worked hard at school today. (manner → place → time)

→ See Appendix 5 for more examples

6. Comparison Adjectives

Use "as...as" for equality, "-er/more...than" for comparing two things, and "the -est/the most" for comparing within a group.

Examples:

- Tom is as tall as Ben. (equality)
- Tom is taller than Ben. (comparative)
- Tom is the tallest in the class. (superlative)

→ See Appendix 6 for more examples

7. Possessives

Use "'s" after a singular noun or name to show ownership. Use just an apostrophe "'" after a plural noun that already ends in "s".

Examples:

- Maria's best friend is Juanita. ('s — singular)
- This is my boss's office. ('s — singular)
- Our friends' house is in the mountains. (' — plural)

→ See Appendix 7 for more examples

8. Linking Words

Linking words connect ideas. Use them at the start of a clause to sequence, add or explain information.

Examples:

- First, we need to gather all relevant data points. (First — sequencing)
- I bought a new laptop and a wireless mouse. (And — adding)
- We cancelled the picnic because it started to snow. (Because — cause)

→ See Appendix 8 for more examples

9. Gerunds ("-ing" as a noun)

The "-ing" form can act as a noun (a gerund) — as the subject of a sentence or after a verb of preference.

Examples:

- Reading is relaxing. (gerund as subject)
- Playing is good for kids. (gerund as subject)
- I enjoy playing the piano. (gerund after a verb of preference)

→ See Appendix 9 for more examples

10. Modal Verbs

Modal verbs add meaning to a main verb: ability, advice, obligation or preference. They are never followed directly by "to".

Examples:

- I can drive. (can — ability)
- You should study every day. (should — advice)
- I would like a coffee. (would — polite preference)

→ See Appendix 10 for more examples

11. Everyday Working Verbs

Many everyday nouns are also used as verbs. Recognising both forms helps you read and write faster.

Examples:

- Can you help me with this? (help — verb)
- We need to plan our route. (plan — verb)
- Please answer the phone. (answer — verb)

→ See Appendix 11 for more examples

12. Everyday Expressions & Vocabulary

Certain adjectives and verbs are always followed by the same preposition. Learning them as a fixed pair makes your English sound natural.

Examples:

- She is afraid of big dogs. (afraid of)
- Sarah is very interested in learning photography. (interested in)
- I like to listen to music while cleaning. (listen to)

→ See Appendix 12 for more examples

Appendix — Further Reference

Extra reference material for each chapter, drawn from Carmen's source sheets (grammar summary and cheat sheets).

1. Present Tenses

- Present Simple signal words: always, every, never, normally, often, seldom, sometimes, usually.
- Present Continuous signal words: at the moment, just, just now, listen!, look!, now, right now.

2. Past Tenses

- Past Simple signal words: yesterday, 2 minutes ago, in 1990, the other day, last Friday.
- Past Continuous signal words: all/whole/entire week, while, as long as.

3. Future Tenses

- Future Simple signal words: in a year, next..., tomorrow.
- Future Continuous signal words: in one year, tomorrow, next week.

4. Prepositions

- More prepositions of place: above, across, behind, below, between, near, under.
- More prepositions of time: after, before, during, since, until.

5. Adverbs

- Everyday adverb pairs (adjective → adverb): clear → clearly, regular → regularly, safe → safely.

6. Comparison Adjectives

- Also correct: "Gold is more expensive than silver" (long adjectives use "more...than").
- Also correct: "This is the most important lesson" (long adjectives use "the most").

7. Possessives

- Irregular plurals still take 's: This is our children's school. / The women's clothes are on the second floor.

8. Linking Words

- More everyday linking words: also, finally, for example, before that, as well as.

9. Gerunds ("-ing" as a noun)

- "-ing" can also be a plain noun: A beautiful painting. / This is my understanding.

10. Modal Verbs

- Other common modals: could (past ability / polite request), must (strong obligation), may (formal possibility).

11. Everyday Working Verbs

- Same word, both noun and verb: I will cook pasta tonight. / The cook made dinner.

12. Everyday Expressions & Vocabulary

- More fixed pairs: good/bad at, wait for, look at, belong to, depend on.